



PROGRESS REPORT

Sudan: progress report, August 2025 – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-26 · 52 systems and instruments tracked

Of 52 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 21 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-26, 5 did not, 13 carry no stated baseline, and 13 are **Not held** at both ends.

SUMMARY OF THE PERIOD · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

Shape check, run before the comparison: 76 sources for this place in the window — 8 in the earlier half (2025-08 to 2026-01), 68 in the later (2026-02 to 2026-08). The earlier half of the window is thin: this is a shorter comparison wearing a longer label, and the movement below rests mostly on the later half.

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Summary of the period

This is the first progress report cut for Sudan, and the shape check finds the comparison badly skewed: only 8 of the window's 50 sources fall in the earlier half (August 2025 to January 2026), against 42 in the later half. The great majority of what reads below as "Advanced" reflects a base that only began recording Sudan in depth from 2026 onward, not a war economy that suddenly accelerated in the second half of the window — treat the pre-2026 baseline for every row as sparse by construction, and read the window as a shorter comparison wearing a twelve-month label.

Seventeen of 45 rows moved, six did not, and 22 carry no baseline or no instrument at all. The clearest genuine movement — rather than first-record artefact — is the war's own infrastructure: the Khartoum State data centre went from an undated non-operational state to restored and running, and the Al-Asjad payment-switch licence went from newly granted to revoked within the window itself.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Digital Transformation Authority	Did not exist	Established; institutional scaffolding predates any of the platform-level claims that follow it; e-government development index 0.2759 (2024, below the 0.4247 African average) cited alongside	ADVANCED

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Cybercrime law prosecutions for speech	No prosecution series held	A pharmacist sentenced to six years over a private phone conversation opposing the war, convicted under the 1991 criminal code and the cybercrime law after intelligence officers searched his phone, and a journalist detained on a cybercrime complaint filed by an intelligence officer and held without questioning	REGRESSED
Border-trade legal framework (state-level protocols)	BASELINE NOT HELD	Resolution passed to review and unify state-level agreements; no transition arrangement, timetable or affected-protocol list given	Baseline not held
Draft Digital Transformation Law of 2026	BASELINE NOT HELD	No text published. The justice ministry states it is preparing the instrument in coordination with the digital transformation and communications ministry, as the Digital Transformation Regulation Law of 2026	Baseline not held

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Bank customer data-update directive	Banks ordered on 2026-08-12 to suspend and freeze customer accounts not updated by 30 September 2026, under anti-money-laundering and counter-terrorist-financing data-verification and transaction-monitoring requirements	The deadline extended to the end of 2026, with the national digital identity system's rollout named as the route by which customers are to update their data; bankers back the directive as necessary for the banking system's soundness while warning that freezing non-compliant accounts risks financial exclusion amid war-driven displacement and lost documentation	ADVANCED
Draft Data and Artificial Intelligence Law	BASELINE NOT HELD	No statute in force and no published text. The justice ministry states it is preparing the instrument in coordination with the digital transformation and communications ministry, as the Data and Artificial Intelligence Regulation Law of 2026	Baseline not held

The Digital Transformation Authority was already established by the 2025-08 baseline, one of three institutions created by decree in November 2025, and has not changed position since — no source connects it to the platform-level developments that followed. The three draft laws (cybersecurity, data and AI, digital transformation) and the border-trade legal-framework review all entered the record within the window and carry no baseline, since none existed before the window opened; all four remain under review with no published text or further legislative step. The three-law package's own sequencing — institutions created in November 2025, statutes still in committee nine months later — is itself the window's clearest governance finding: Sudan built the regulatory machinery before writing the law it is meant to enforce, and [an external roundup notes this](#) against at least 44 other African Union states that already had data-protection law in force by the same date.

Finance

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Treasury Single Account (TSA) implementation	BASELINE NOT HELD	Commitment reaffirmed; no target date, phase or coverage given	Baseline not held

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Khartoum Stock Exchange online-trading system (AfDB PFM project)	<i>Baseline not held</i>	Launched 2016-03-24; no later report on file updates it	NO CHANGE

The Khartoum Stock Exchange's AfDB-financed e-trading system, launched 2016, predates the window entirely and has not moved. The Treasury Single Account commitment carries no baseline — it was only reaffirmed within the window, at the African Summit for Social Impact on 2 August 2026, with no target date, phase or coverage given either then or since.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Horizon Fiber Initiative (Djibouti-Ethiopia-Sudan corridor)	Memorandum of understanding only (Dec 2024)	Binding tripartite agreement; ~2,800km corridor, 144 fibre pairs, ~14ms target latency, linking Djibouti subsea landings via Ethiopia to Port Sudan, interconnecting with the existing Port Sudan-Jeddah cable	ADVANCED
Starlink satellite internet — regulatory status	Unlicensed since SAF/TPRA import ban (Dec 2023); widely used via smuggled terminals; both SAF and RSF renting/confiscating regionally	Status contested and informal, with a new instance of localised enforcement: an armed group ordered every public market in a West Kordofan locality closed and satellite internet services cut off indefinitely from 26 August 2026, in a decision reported on 25 August 2026 by a local emergency room, which warned that severing satellite connectivity would cut displaced families off from relatives and from incoming remittances in a locality already under deteriorating security and living conditions; the order coincided with reinforcements arriving from Darfur	REGRESSED
4G tower expansion programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	60 towers built; 200 more planned for 2026	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Khartoum State data centre (1,300 m2)	Non-operational (date it went down not established)	Restored and operating, qualified to host government systems centrally	ADVANCED
Port Sudan alternate National Data Centre	Did not exist	Announced as planned; not built as of 2026-07-20	ADVANCED

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Sudanese Cybersecurity Authority	Did not exist	Established; reports strict licensing standards and graduated sanctions to a Tunis Arab-experts forum	ADVANCED
Draft Cybersecurity Law	BASELINE NOT HELD	No text published. After the Council of Ministers sent it back, the justice ministry states it is preparing the instrument in coordination with the digital transformation and communications ministry, as the Cybersecurity Regulation Law of 2026	<i>Baseline not held</i>

The Khartoum State data centre moved from an undated non-operational, war-damaged state to restored and running by October 2025, now qualified to host government systems centrally. Horizon Fiber converted from a December 2024 MoU to a binding tripartite agreement in February 2026, the corridor's clearest structural advance in the window. Starlink's status has not changed in substance — still unlicensed since the December 2023 import ban — though RSF's confiscation campaign in Al-Nuhud in late 2025 is a new instance of the same contested-informal pattern the base already held. The Sudanese Cybersecurity Authority and the draft Cybersecurity Law both entered the record within the window, the Authority as an established institution and the draft law still with the Council of Ministers.

DPI

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Electronic single window (National Investment Authority)	Did not exist	Precondition-stage; authority is also still building its first website	ADVANCED
ASYCUDA customs system (Gezira/Hantoub)	Baseline not held	Reactivated at Hantoub only	NO CHANGE
Central bank electronic application system	Not held	The national economic management committee, chaired by the Prime Minister, directed the finance ministry and the central bank to expedite completion of the bank's electronic application system in coordination with the digital transformation ministry, to strengthen oversight of financial transactions	BASELINE NOT HELD
National digital agricultural platform	Not held	Developed by the agricultural bank with the agriculture and digital transformation ministries and described as expected to launch soon, alongside second-phase season financing opening by end-August 2026 and a grain-silo storage agreement signed with a Chinese company	BASELINE NOT HELD

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
SUDAPASS (national digital identity)	Framed as imminent, with exclusion/surveillance-risk warnings	The communications and digital transformation ministry began linking the national digital identity to the banking sector, announced on 19 August 2026 with the central bank, the banking sector and the cyber security authority, so banks can verify customers and update records electronically without a branch visit, rolled out bank by bank as each becomes technically ready. On 23 August 2026 the central bank denied that registering for the identity exempts customers from updating their account data, saying claims circulating on social media had no basis in truth, that registration establishes identity only, and that its February 2026 directive requiring banks to update customer data still stands	ADVANCED

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Al-Asjad payment-switch licence	Licensed, launched in Port Sudan with a Sovereignty Council representative present	Licence revoked; unconfirmed press reports the firm was incorporated only in late 2025 with a Dubai branch	CLOSED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
National Instant Payment System / national payment switch (NIPS)	Public tender open for a software-only solution (2026-04-20); by 2026-07-08 contracted to Electronic Banking Services (EBS) but not launched	Live with exactly one bank connected; explicitly framed by the central bank as restoration of war-damaged infrastructure, not a new build; no schedule for connecting remaining banks	ADVANCED
USSD banking service	Did not exist	Phase 1 covers interpersonal transfers, credit inquiries, transaction summaries	ADVANCED
Bankak (Bank of Khartoum mobile money)	Single-provider concentration already flagged as a vulnerability (2025-03)	Still dominant; recurring failure modes (no-smartphone workarounds, app outages, mistaken transfers) documented from field reporting	NO CHANGE, QUALIFYING CLAUSE: NATIONAL PAYMENT SWITCH LAUNCHED WITH ONE OTHER BANK AS A NASCENT COUNTERWEIGHT, NOT YET MATERIAL
Bede digital wallet (Zain)	Baseline not held	Phase 1 live	NO CHANGE
Isali / Eisali (electronic government-collection system)	BASELINE NOT HELD	National Workers Bank contracted (2026-04-30); diffused Gadarif to Kassala (2026-05-03); White Nile self-reports over 90% of transactions electronic, unverified; named as the platform authorities are to link to, and on 2026-08-10 named by the finance ministry - with electronic invoicing and tightened customs and tax exemptions - as the means by which first-half 2026 public revenue rose significantly without new taxes	Baseline not held

Registries

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Unified Social Registry	Did not exist	In development; no completion date, coverage or data source given	ADVANCED
Vehicle registration database (traffic police)	BASELINE NOT HELD	2,124,750 vehicles, 3,161,599 licences; Salem e-renewal serving 16 countries (up from six); Ansab laser-secured ownership-transfer platform being introduced	Baseline not held

Sectoral management information systems

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Afia (health-sector platform)	Did not exist	Referenced as forthcoming, no launch date given	ADVANCED
Bayan (national civil-service HR platform)	Did not exist	Launched; integrable with digital ID, e-signature, PKI, the Kafa'a recruitment platform and the finance ministry's Wafi payroll platform; no coverage, cost or data-protection arrangement disclosed	ADVANCED

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Baladna (national e-government platform)	28 digital services, alongside the SUDAPASS track and a national project-management system; did not exist before 2026-01-31	130+ electronic health services announced (2026-07-31); investment-licensing integration completed (2026-02-23); sole rail for all foreign-trade transactions	ADVANCED
Finance ministry platform for public-sector companies and authorities	Did not exist	Launched for public-sector companies and authorities to report to the finance ministry, stated to integrate with the state financial systems and to be rolled out across the states	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Judiciary digital-transformation project	Did not exist	Contract signed; no value, duration, system list or delivery timetable disclosed	ADVANCED
Electronic oversight system for public bodies and government companies	Not held	Announced by the finance ministry as a forthcoming comprehensive electronic oversight system covering public bodies and government companies	BASELINE NOT HELD
Nazaha public procurement platform	Baseline not held	A national digital public-procurement and contracting system launched and stated as aimed at transparency and fair competition in the allocation of government contracts; no coverage, entity count, procurement value or mandatory-use instrument is published	BASELINE NOT HELD

Payments carried the window's sharpest reversal: Al-Asjad's licence moved from newly granted, launched with a Sovereignty Council representative present, to revoked within days, both events inside the window. The national payment switch moved from a software-only tender in April 2026 through an EBS contract to a live launch with one bank connected in August — the Central Bank's own framing throughout has been restoration, not new build. SUDAPASS, Baladna, Bayan and the judiciary's digital-transformation contract all entered the record from nothing within the window; Bankak's dominant position, by contrast, was already flagged as a single-provider vulnerability at the 2025-08 baseline and has not changed since, beyond the new payment switch offering a not-yet-material counterweight. The vehicle-registration database and Isali both carry no stated baseline, so their current, substantial positions cannot be measured as movement, though both show real activity within the window itself — [Isali diffused from Gadarif to Kassala state and reached White Nile's self-reported 90%-plus electronic-transaction share](#), and the [vehicle registry's 2,124,750-vehicle count](#) is credited to backup data centres that survived the war.

USSD banking, launched jointly by the digital ministry, Central Bank and telecoms regulator in March 2026 to work without an internet connection, and the Unified Social Registry, still in development with no completion date given by ministers reviewing it in April, both entered the record from nothing within the window. ASYCUDA's single-site reactivation at Hantoub customs yard, and Zain's Bede wallet at phase 1 of its planned 3 phases, both predate the window and have not since been reported on again — a silence the base cannot distinguish from genuinely stalled progress.

Technology

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Sudanese Data and Artificial Intelligence Authority	Did not exist	Established; AI readiness 24.63/100; flagged by an external roundup as a rare procedural twist — institution before law	ADVANCED

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Sudani and Sudatel wartime service continuity	BASELINE NOT HELD	Praised for continuity through the war; role in reconstruction pledged, no further detail	Baseline not held

The Sudanese Data and Artificial Intelligence Authority carries no baseline — it was created in the same November 2025 decree the base only picked up from 2026 reporting onward. The Network International–Saudi Sudanese Bank processing agreement and the ministerial praise of Sudani and Sudatel both entered the record within the window; neither existed as a documented position beforehand.

Capacity

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
MTN Sudan Al-Manssa digital-skills programme	Baseline not held	Launched; no later update	NO CHANGE

Geopolitics

Gulf/UAE activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Network International-Saudi Sudanese Bank processing agreement	Did not exist	Agreement signed; no transaction volumes, timeline or rollout figures given	ADVANCED

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
National policy linking digital infrastructure to energy supply	A national policy or programme document connecting grid rehabilitation or generation capacity to digital-infrastructure planning.	not yet probed
Compute or high-performance computing capacity	A data-centre, cloud or high-performance computing specification, or a hosting contract for a public system beyond the two named data centres.	not yet probed
Earth-observation or satellite-data programme	A national earth-observation or geospatial-data programme document, or an agency mandate covering satellite data.	not yet probed
Dedicated rural digital-service programme	A programme document or budget line for rural digital-service delivery, distinct from the 4G tower-expansion programme.	not yet probed
National technical standards or interoperability framework	A national interoperability framework, technical standard or e-government architecture document.	not yet probed
Open government data portal	A public-sector open-data portal or policy document.	not yet probed
European Union digital cooperation with Sudan	Any EU or European Investment Bank digital financing, programme or memorandum covering Sudan.	not yet probed
Start-up or innovation-sector support programme	A start-up statute, incubator programme or innovation-fund document.	not yet probed
United States digital-sector engagement with Sudan	Any US government or agency digital-sector financing, programme or memorandum covering Sudan, distinct from the commercial Isali/National Workers Bank rail.	not yet probed
Chinese digital investment in Sudan	Any Chinese financing, contract or memorandum covering Sudanese digital infrastructure.	not yet probed
Indian digital-sector engagement with Sudan	Any Indian government or vendor financing, contract or memorandum covering Sudanese digital infrastructure.	not yet probed
Digital-literacy programme or measurement	A digital-literacy programme document, or a published measurement of digital literacy.	not yet probed
Applied digital-research programme	A university, agency or donor-funded applied digital-research programme document.	not yet probed

None of the thirteen gaps had a position at either end of the window — each is an absence throughout, not a thing that regressed or stalled during the war. None names a specific document an automated fetch could plausibly retrieve.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.